



Our Mission

OpenLabs is a nonprofit community wet lab dedicated to expanding access to independent scientific innovation across Orange County. We empower students, researchers, and early-stage entrepreneurs by providing affordable bench space, professional-grade laboratory equipment, a biomedical engineering makerspace, and full ownership of all intellectual property developed on-site. All members have the freedom to pursue independent experimentation, schedule their own lab hours, and control costs through a scalable membership model that ensures they pay only for the capabilities they need. Fully equipped for BSL-1 molecular biology and cellular experimentation, OpenLabs creates an accessible environment where ideas can move from concept to validated results.

Membership

\$50.00/monthly

Starter

Basic molecular biology capabilities:

- Environmental sampling
- Microscopy
- Fermentation monitoring
- Microbial and yeast culture
- Shared 4° and -20° fridge space

\$125.00/monthly

Standard

- Full molecular biology capabilities
- Unlimited free access to consumables (pipette tips, conical tubes, well plates)
- Discounted reagent inventory
- Shared 4°, -20°, and -80° fridge space
- 1 bench per person
- Reserve benches a month in advance

\$145.00/monthly

Premium

- Reserved fridge space
- Reagent lockboxes
- Multiple benches per person
- Reserve benches year in advance

Additional Services

Cell Culture Room

Standard Membership + \$50.00/month

Our dedicated cell culture room is equipped with 2 Biosafety Cabinets, CO2 incubators, and inverted microscopy following strict aseptic technique to ensure your BSL-1 cell lines remain healthy and safe from cross-contamination.

Biomedical Engineering Makerspace

\$50.00/month

Our Makerspace is equipped with 3D resin and SLA printers, laser cutters, a soldering station, and more to prototype and test your medical device innovation. Steps away from our wet lab, you can seamlessly transition from hardware to biological validation in one workflow.

Lockers

Starter Membership + \$5.00/month

Keep your work-in-progress safe and confidential without the hassle of daily transport. Our dedicated lockers will protect your intellectual property and physical prototypes right in our facility, ready for the next iteration.

Reagent Aliquots

Standard Membership

Stop paying for 20 mL when you only need a couple uL. Our Shared Reagent Inventory allows you to purchase aliquots of enzymes, buffers and reagents at a fraction of the cost. By leveraging our collective purchasing power, we provide essentials like Taq polymerase, media, and BSL-1 cell lines at significantly reduced rates.

Eligibility

All members **MUST**:

- Be over the age of 18
- Complete our laboratory safety certification online course (\$30)
- Complete training for user-specific laboratory work
- Receive project approval from our Safety & Ethics Review to ensure work is strictly BSL1
- Submit signed user agreement and code of conduct

To protect our user-owned IP model, our membership contracts include strict non-disclosure and non-interference clauses. OpenLabs maintains a zero-tolerance policy for sanitation and safety violations. Failure to follow these protocols results in immediate membership review or revocation.

1-Day Molecular Biology Classes

Gene Cloning

\$35.00

- Plasmid Double Digest and Ligation
- Gel Electrophoresis and Extraction

Bacterial Culture

\$35.00

- Bacterial Transformation and Culture
- Colony Screening
- Plasmid Miniprep

Cell Culture

\$45.00

- Cell Seeding and Passaging
- Cell Counting
- Cell Viability Assays

Gene Quantification

\$35.00

- RNA Isolation
- PCR amplification
- RTPCR and qPCR

Protein Analysis

\$45.00

- Protein Extraction
- BCA Assay
- Western Blot

Cellular Research Track

The OpenLabs Cellular Research Track is a flexible, hypothesis-driven research program that trains participants to investigate real biological questions using professional biotechnology methods, preparing them for independent scientific inquiry. Through modular, hands-on laboratory sessions and complementary online coursework, students generate mechanistic data and produce publication-quality figures that are integrated into a collaborative research manuscript. Participants schedule their own lab hours, select the in-person experiments they wish to perform, pay only for the laboratory work they complete, and receive authorship recognition based on meaningful contribution.

Learn more [here](#).

Financial Aid

Undergraduate participants are eligible to apply for need-based scholarships that may partially or fully cover membership costs. Applicants must submit financial information and a project proposal overview through the financial aid form for consideration.